Extra Dessert #22: Final Mixed Practice and Weak-Area Diagnostic

How to use practice-exam misses to find weak groups and target exactly which Bite, Course, or Dessert to revisit.

System organizer · Use after taking practice exams · Self-study reference · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

When To Use This Sheet

You have been through the Bites, Courses, and topic-owned Desserts. Now take a full 50-question practice exam (HamStudy.org, ARRL exam review, QRZ practice). Mark down every question you missed – not just the topic, but the **exam group ID** shown next to the question (E1A, E6B, etc.).

That list of group IDs is your weak-area diagnostic. This sheet tells you exactly which study material owns each group, so you go straight to the right Bite/Course/Dessert and re-read it. No general flailing.

Triage Rule

Sort your missed questions into three buckets:

Bucket	Action
Reserved group (E5B, E5C, E6C, E7G, E8C, E8D, E9G)	Expected. Don't spend time here unless you are already passing the rest. On exam day, educated-guess these.
Covered group, missed 1 question	Re-read the cheat sheet and common-traps section of the owning module. 5-10 minutes.
Covered group, missed 2+ questions	Re-read the entire teaching content of the owning module. 15-30 minutes. Mark "Weak" on your D19 score tracker.

Group-to-Module Lookup (Covered Groups)

If you missed a question from group X, revisit module Y.

Group	Module	Topic / where the answer lives
E0A	D5	Safety, RF exposure, grounding
E1A	D12	Frequency privileges and band edges
E1B	D13	Station restrictions, RACES
E1C	D6	Auto/remote control, foreign ops, emission rules
E1D	D7	Space and Earth stations, telemetry
E1E	D14	VE and exam administration
E1F	D15	Misc rules: external amps, spread spectrum, STA
E2A	D8	Satellite operations
E2B	D9	Television (ATV and SSTV)
E2C	D10	DX, contest, remote operating
E2D	D16	VHF/UHF digital, APRS, EME procedures
E2E	D3	HF digital modes
E3A	D1	Specialized propagation (EME, meteor, auroral)
E3B	D4	Propagation effects (TEP, long-path, sporadic-E)
E3C	D11	Propagation prediction and space weather
E4A	D17	Test equipment (scopes, spectrum, antenna analyzer)
E4B + E4C	EC-B	VNA, S-parameters, noise floor, MDS
E4D	B13	Dynamic range and intermod (uses EC-B)
E4E	D2	Noise and interference
E5A	EC-A	Resonance, Q, bandwidth
E5D	B5	Skin effect, reactive power, RF parasitics
E6A	B3	Semiconductor device recognition
E6B	B10	Diodes (Zener, Schottky, PIN, varactor)
E6D	B11	Inductors, transformers, piezoelectric
E6E	B4	MMICs and RF packaging
E6F	B12	Electro-optical devices
E7A	B14	Digital logic, truth tables
E7B	B6	Amplifier classes, transistor stages
E7C	B17	Filters and matching networks (uses EC-A)
E7D	B1	Power supplies and regulators
E7E	B15	Modulators, detectors, mixers

E7F	B7	SDR and DSP basics
E7H	B8	Oscillators, synthesizers, PLL
E8A + E8B	EC-D	Fourier, RMS, PEP, ADC, modulation index, OFDM
E9A + E9F	EC-C	Antenna basics, ERP/EIRP, transmission lines
E9B	B16	Antenna patterns and modeling
E9C	B2	Practical wire antennas, phased arrays
E9D	B9	Yagis, parabolic, short antennas
E9E	B18	Impedance matching, phasing lines
E9H	D18	Receiving antennas (RDF, Beverages, loops)

Cross-Cutting Drill Sheets

For pattern-recognition or symbol-recognition questions, use the drill Desserts:

Drill	When to use it
D20 (Symbol drill)	If you missed a question that includes “Figure E6-1” or “Figure E6-2”, or any device-recognition question across E6/E7.
D21 (Antenna figure / pattern drill)	If you missed a question that references Figure E9-1 or E9-2, or any pattern-naming question in E9B, E9C, E9D, E9E, or E9H.

Readiness Self-Check

You are ready when:

- You score **37+ on practice exams consistently** (three in a row, different sessions).
- Misses are concentrated in **reserved groups** (E5B, E5C, E6C, E7G, E8C, E8D, E9G), not scattered.
- Every covered group has at most one “Weak” mark on your D19 tracker.
- You can name the pattern from a recipe (two verticals + spacing + phase) without looking it up.
- You can identify all official figures (E6-1 FET symbols 1 and 4, E6-2 Schottky (symbol 6), E7-1 common-emitter circuit, E7-2 linear regulator, E9-1 azimuth, E9-2 elevation) in under 5 seconds each.

If those five hold, schedule the exam. If two or more do not, do one more 8-week pass through the weak groups before scheduling.

Final reminder: the exam draws **one question per group**. Hitting 86% accuracy on the 43 covered groups while guessing 25% on the 7 reserved groups projects to 38 of 50 – one above pass. That math is your floor; well-studied learners exceed it. Use practice exams to verify **coverage**, not just total score.